Data Request for a Thesis Study

Arkidom Development Corporation, Quezon City

Group Statisfied, CS0025 Thesis, TS31

We are four Computer Science students working on our thesis under the guidance of our adviser. Our thesis needs a real firm that is willing to share its project records. This sheet lists exactly which records we would ask from the firm, so the owners can see right away what is needed and what is not.

What We Would Like To Study

We want to use the firm's own completed project records to build a cost estimator for new projects and an early warning for projects that may run over budget or schedule. The estimate would help with quoting new projects.

The Records We Are Asking For

The first row of each table is the one we need most. The others help the study but are optional.

Record	What Each Entry Should Show	Why We Need It
Project list (most needed)	One line per completed project since 2021. A project code instead of the name. Year. Type of project (house, commercial, renovation, and so on). Design only, design and build, or construction only. City or province. Floor area and number of floors. Contract amount and final cost. Planned and actual start and end dates. A short reason if it went over budget or late.	This is the main data. It shows how cost and time relate to the size and type of project.
Bill of quantities or cost line items	One line per cost item of each project. Item description, group (for example earthworks, structural, architectural, electrical, plumbing, finishing), unit, quantity, unit cost and amount. The actual cost of the item if it is tracked.	Many items per project give the study enough records, since 5,000 are needed.
Change orders and revisions	The date of each change, the reason, the amount added or removed, and the days added to the schedule.	Changes are a common cause of overruns.
Material purchase prices	The material, unit, price and date of purchase.	To adjust old costs for price increases.
Monthly progress (optional)	Percent complete at the end of each month for each project.	To study schedule delays.

Period and Size

Projects from January 2021 up to today. Our school asks for at least 5,000 records from 2021 onward. A project with a bill of quantities of a few hundred lines already gives a few hundred records, so about 15 to 20 projects with line items would be enough. If the firm keeps only one total per project, tell us how many projects there are and we will discuss the next step with our adviser.

Format

Excel or CSV is best. PDF copies of bills of quantities are fine, and we will do the typing ourselves with the firm's permission.

Privacy

- We do not need client names, addresses, plans, drawings or signatures. Projects are identified by a code, and anything that names a client is removed before anyone in the group analyzes the data.
- We follow the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173).
- The records are used only for this thesis, with the firm's written permission, and are kept private. We can delete them after the thesis if the firm wishes. We can also sign a non-disclosure agreement.
- The firm's name can be hidden in the final paper if the owners prefer.

What You Get Back

A simple estimator that gives the expected cost of a new project with a range and the main factors behind it, and a warning when a project looks likely to run over. The group would present it to the owners.

Three Questions To Answer First

1. How many projects has the firm completed since 2021?
2. Do you keep bills of quantities in Excel, and do you record both the contract amount and the final cost?
3. Who approves sharing the records, and is it fine if the projects are anonymized?